

NICHOLAS GUMBS

Automation Engineer

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SUMMARY

Automation Engineer with 5+ years of experience supporting cloud-native web and backend systems through infrastructure automation, CI/CD pipelines, and platform reliability initiatives. Proven ability to improve deployment confidence, system resilience, and release quality at scale. Comfortable in both quality engineering and platform/DevOps engineering role where strong automation, debugging, and systems analysis skills add immediate value.

SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EKS, S3, Aurora, OpenSearch, VPC, CloudFront, DynamoDB), GCP (GKE, GCS), Kubernetes, Docker, MySQL

Quality Engineering & Reliability: E2E (Cypress/Playwright), Performance, Load (JMeter/Locust), API (Postman), Accessibility, Manual

Programming & Scripting: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Bash, SQL

Platform, CI/CD & Observability: Terraform, Gyro (IaC), GitHub Actions, Argo Workflows, Helm, Datadog, Coralogix

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate May 2025 - May 2028

EXPERIENCE

Brightspot

Nov 2020 - Present

Automation Engineer

- Owned the design and maintenance of CI-integrated test frameworks (Cypress + GitHub Actions), cutting regression execution time by 63%, from 8 hours to under 3.
- Covered manual testing across the full SDLC (exploratory, regression, UAT, and release sign-off), working with product and engineering to set acceptance criteria, troubleshooting environment issues, and validate deployments before go-live.
- Served as a point of contact for clients and internal stakeholders, translating requirements into technical solutions and keeping platform capabilities aligned with business objectives.
- Advocate for AI-assisted development tooling to accelerate test generation, code review, and documentation workflows.

Infrastructure & Platform Reliability

- Extended and maintained a modular, multi-environment Gyro (IaC) codebase across multi-tenant AWS and GCP resources: EKS clusters, Aurora, OpenSearch, CloudFront, VPC, and DNS, with consistent patterns applied across client projects.
- Designed and validated multi-region AWS deployments with active-active and pilot-light failover strategies, cross-region replication, and automated disaster recovery to eliminate single points of failure.
- Automated the secure rollout of AI capabilities across customer environments using Python scripts for cross-account IAM role provisioning and assume-role configuration, enforcing cost tracking and least-privilege access controls.
- Drove production releases and blue/green rollouts on EKS clusters, scripting Helm and IaC updates in Python and Bash to reduce manual steps and improve consistency across multi-environment stacks.
- Audited the Apache installation against the CIS benchmark, evaluating each control as fulfilled, failed, or mitigated through compensating measures and producing remediation recommendations for the security team.

Incident Response

- Held on-call responsibilities across a tiered alert system, prioritizing uptime SLAs and taking ownership of high and low severity alerts to keep response backlog clear and resolve issues before customer impact.
- Wrote detailed postmortems and internal incident summaries for major outages, covering symptoms, investigation steps, and resolution; these fed directly into customer-facing RCAs and informed follow-up work to prevent recurrence.

Associated Press News

- Owned load testing strategy for the 2024 U.S. presidential election, simulating millions of concurrent users across failover scenarios and achieving 100% uptime during peak traffic.
- Led a cross-functional team to ship a major platform release in 3 months, half the projected 6-month schedule, through coordinated E2E, load, and accessibility testing.

EDUCATION

B.S. Information Systems, Minor in Entrepreneurship

2016 - 2020

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

EXTRACURRICULAR

UMBC Varsity Men's Soccer 2016 - 2020

Guilford Park HS Varsity Soccer Assistant Coach 2023 - Present